Dr. Pramod V. Lokhande
GURUKRUPA SPINE CLINIC

Book Consultation

EXPERT SPINE CARE | PUNE & MUMBAI

Back Pain or Sciatica Affecting Your Life?

Discover your treatment options — including advanced endoscopic spine surgery.

Living with persistent back pain, shooting leg pain, or difficulty walking can affect your work, sleep, and everyday activities. The good news? Not every spine problem requires major surgery.

Dr. Pramod V. Lokhande brings over 24 years of dedicated spine surgery experience, helping patients understand their condition and explore appropriate treatment options. From non-surgical care to advanced full endoscopic spine surgery, your treatment begins with one priority: finding the right solution for your spine.

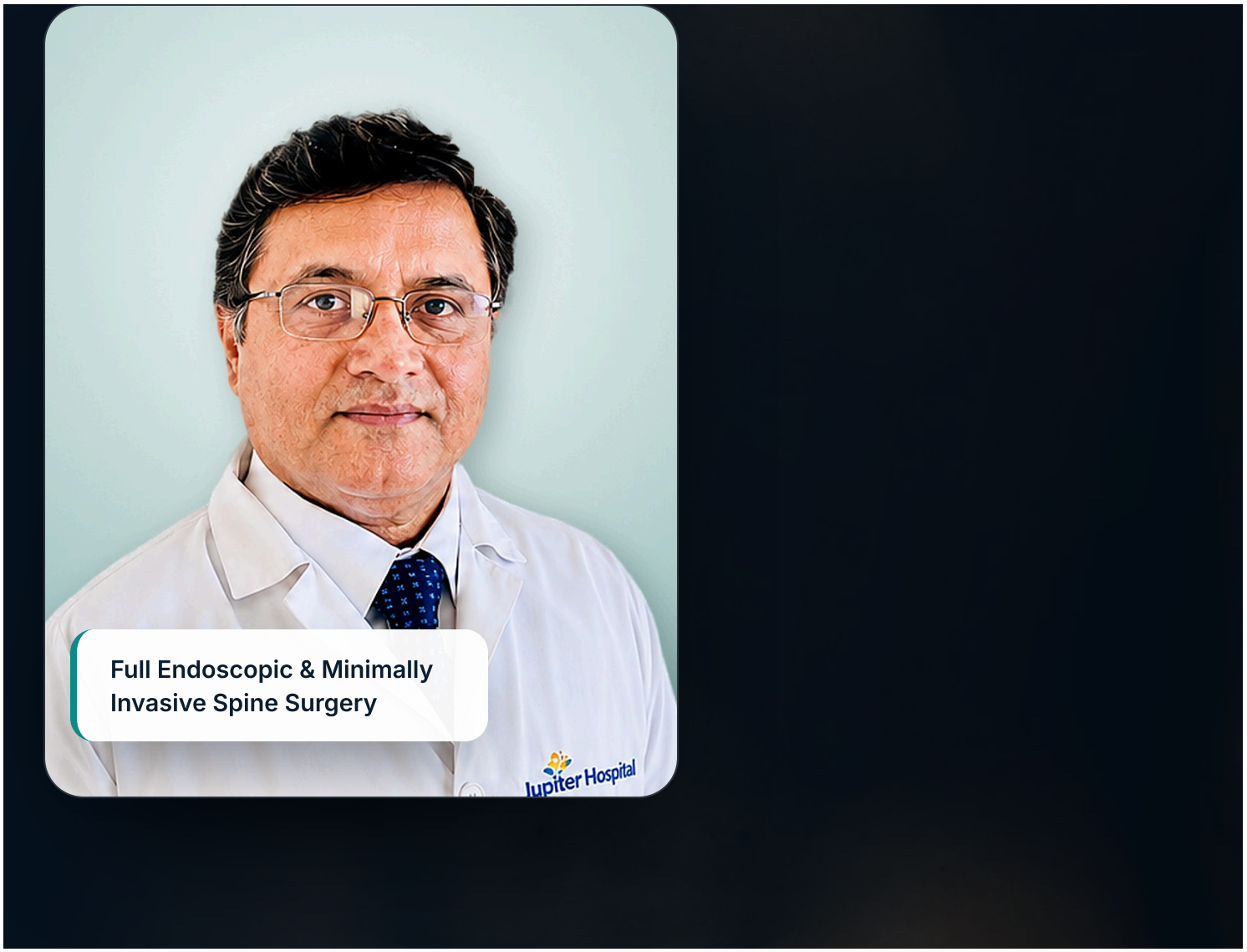
Book a Spine Consultation →

Explore Treatment Options

24+ Years
Dedicated to spine surgery

5,000+
Spine surgeries performed

5 Countries
Advanced fellowship training



UNDERSTANDING YOUR PAIN

Is Back Pain Stopping You from Living Your Life?

You may recognize some of these experiences.

Pain That Travels Down Your Leg

A sharp, burning, or shooting pain from your lower back into your leg may be associated with sciatica or nerve compression.

Difficulty Walking or Standing

Do you need to stop and rest after walking a short distance? Certain spinal conditions can affect the nerves involved in walking.

Numbness or Tingling

Persistent tingling, altered sensation, or weakness in your arms or legs may indicate a problem requiring medical evaluation.

Pain That Keeps Returning

If medication, physiotherapy, or other treatments have not provided sufficient relief, it may be time to review your diagnosis and treatment plan.

Fear of Spine Surgery

Many patients worry about surgical risks, recovery time, and returning to their normal lives. Understanding your options is the first step toward making an informed decision.

You don’t have to make this decision alone.

An experienced spine specialist can help identify the cause of your symptoms and explain the available treatments.

Discuss Your Symptoms



ADVANCED FELLOWSHIP TRAINING

South Korea | Germany | France | Switzerland | Japan

MEET YOUR SPINE SPECIALIST

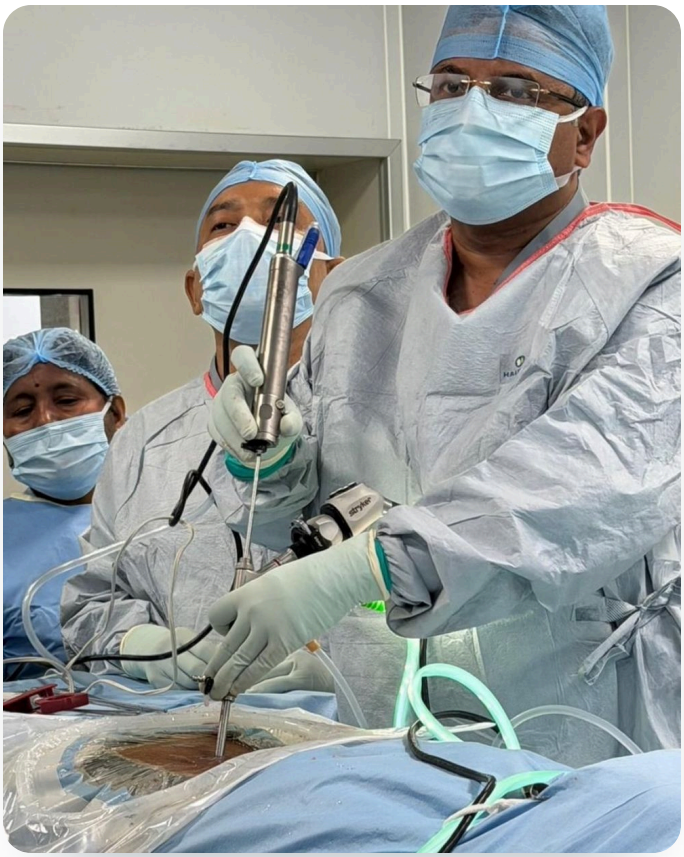
Meet Dr. Pramod V. Lokhande

Experience. Precision. Patient-Centered Care.

With over 24 years dedicated to spine surgery, Dr. Pramod V. Lokhande specializes in full endoscopic and minimally invasive spine procedures. His experience includes the evaluation and treatment of conditions affecting the cervical, thoracic, and lumbar spine.

He has performed more than 5,000 spine surgeries and pursued advanced fellowship training in five countries: South Korea, Germany, France, Switzerland, and Japan.

Dr. Lokhande has also contributed to surgical education through conference lectures, live surgical demonstrations, and training workshops for orthopedic surgeons and neurosurgeons. His clinical approach begins with understanding the patient's condition, symptoms, medical history, and treatment goals.



In the operating room



Lecturing at IOACON 2025

A Thoughtful Approach to Spine Care

1 **Accurate Evaluation**

Understanding the source of pain through clinical examination and appropriate investigations.

2 **Individualized Treatment**

Considering non-surgical and surgical options based on the patient's needs.

3 **Advanced Surgical Expertise**

Using appropriate minimally invasive and endoscopic techniques when clinically indicated.

4 **Clear Communication**

Helping patients understand the benefits, limitations, risks, and expected recovery of their treatment.

Book a Spine Consultation

YOUR HEALTH COMES FIRST

Not Every Spine Problem Needs Surgery.

And not every patient needs the same treatment.

Many spine conditions can initially be managed with appropriate non-surgical treatment. Depending on your diagnosis, this may include medication, physiotherapy, exercise-based rehabilitation, or other specialist-recommended interventions.

When symptoms persist, neurological problems develop, or imaging reveals a condition that may benefit from surgery, an operation may become an appropriate option.

OUR APPROACH

1

Understand the Problem

Review your symptoms, medical history, examination findings, and relevant imaging.

2

Explore the Options

Discuss available treatment choices, including non-surgical care where appropriate.

3

Recommend the Right Treatment

Consider surgical treatment only when the expected benefits justify the risks.

4

Plan Your Recovery

Provide guidance on rehabilitation, follow-up, and returning to daily activities.

The goal is not simply to perform surgery. *The goal is to help you make the right decision for your spine health.*

Book a Spine Consultation

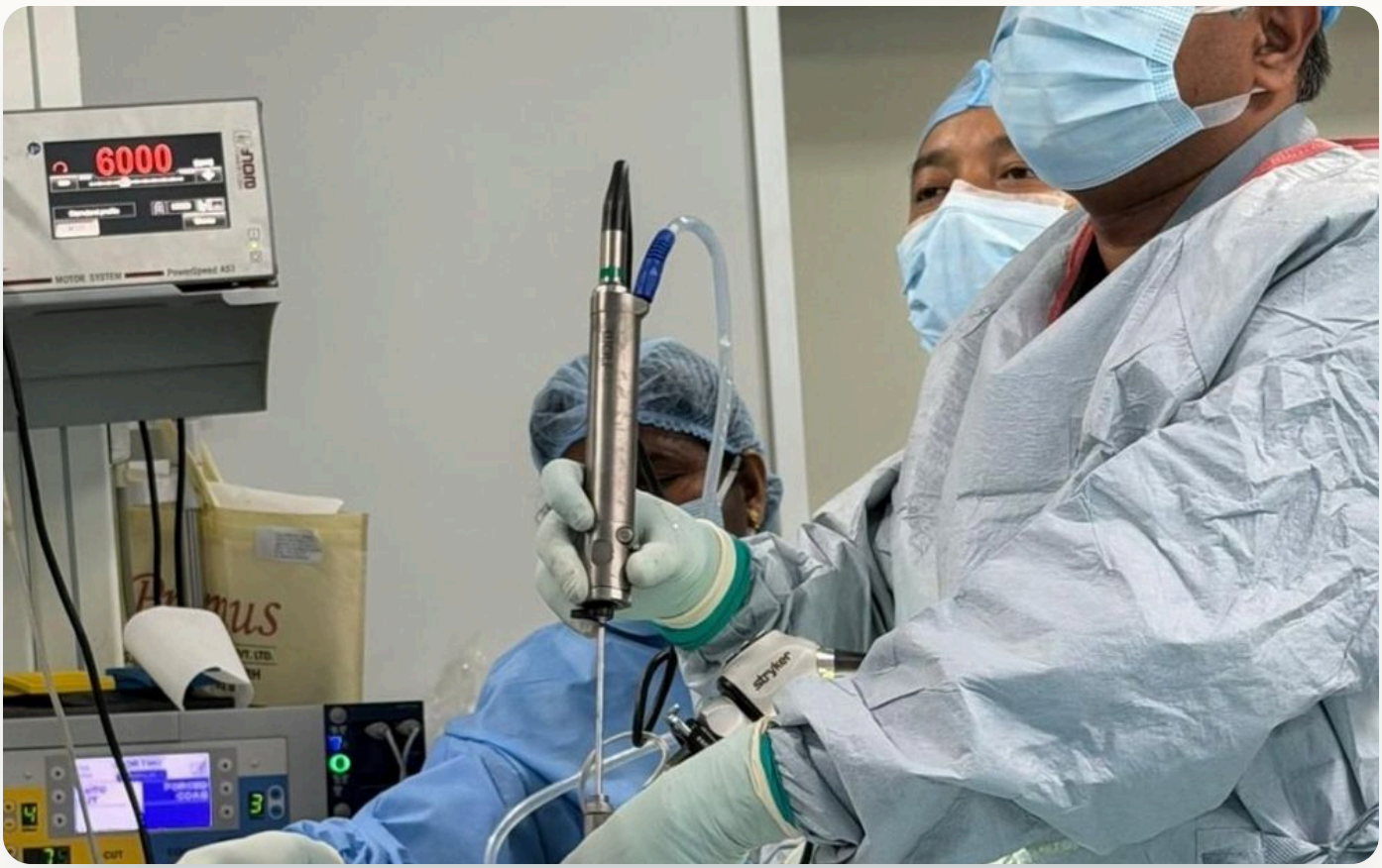
ADVANCED SPINE TREATMENT

Spine Surgery Through a Small Incision.

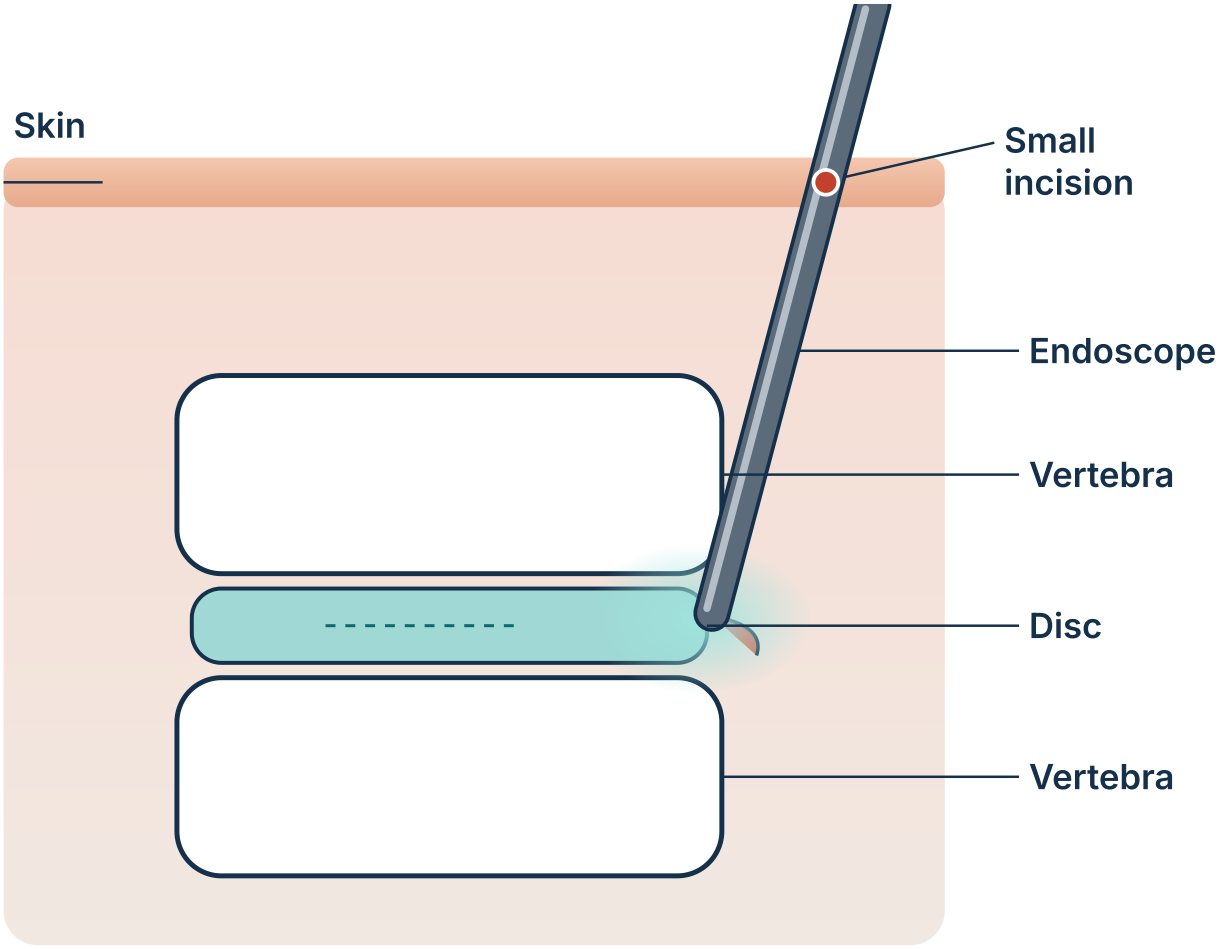
Understanding Full Endoscopic Spine Surgery

Full endoscopic spine surgery is a minimally invasive technique used to treat selected spinal conditions. The surgeon uses a small camera called an endoscope, along with specialized surgical instruments, to access and treat the affected area.

The camera provides a magnified view of the surgical site, allowing the surgeon to work through a relatively small incision. For appropriately selected patients, this approach may reduce disruption to surrounding tissues compared with some traditional open procedures.



Dr. Lokhande performing full endoscopic spine surgery



Educational illustration. Not to scale.

FULL ENDOSCOPIC SPINE SURGERY

Potential Benefits



01

Smaller Incision

Many endoscopic procedures can be performed through a small surgical opening.



02

Reduced Tissue Disruption

Specialized instruments allow access to the affected area while limiting disruption to surrounding muscles and tissues.



03

Direct Visualization

A high-definition endoscope provides a magnified view of the surgical area.



04

Shorter Hospital Stay

Selected patients may be discharged on the same day or after a short hospital stay.



05

Earlier Mobilization

Depending on the procedure and individual recovery, some patients may begin walking shortly after surgery.



06

Recovery Tailored to the Patient

Recovery depends on the condition treated, procedure performed, overall health, and rehabilitation requirements.

Is Endoscopic Spine Surgery Right for Everyone?

No.

Not every spinal condition can be treated effectively through an endoscopic approach. Some patients may benefit more from other minimally invasive procedures, traditional surgery, or non-surgical treatment.

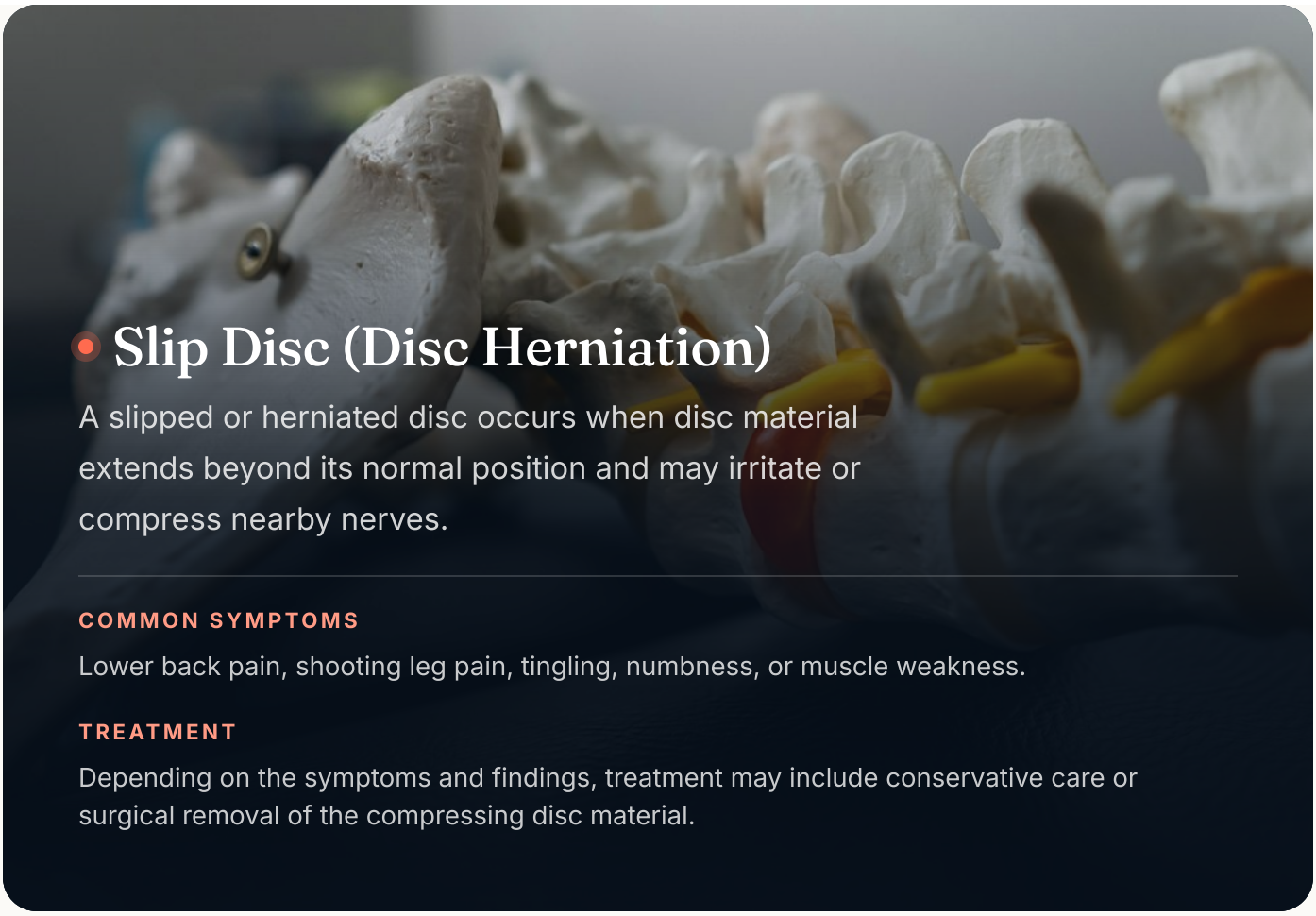
A specialist evaluation is essential before selecting the treatment.

Discuss Your Symptoms

SPINE CONDITIONS

Understanding What's Causing Your Pain

Dr. Lokhande evaluates and treats a wide range of spinal conditions.



Slip Disc (Disc Herniation)

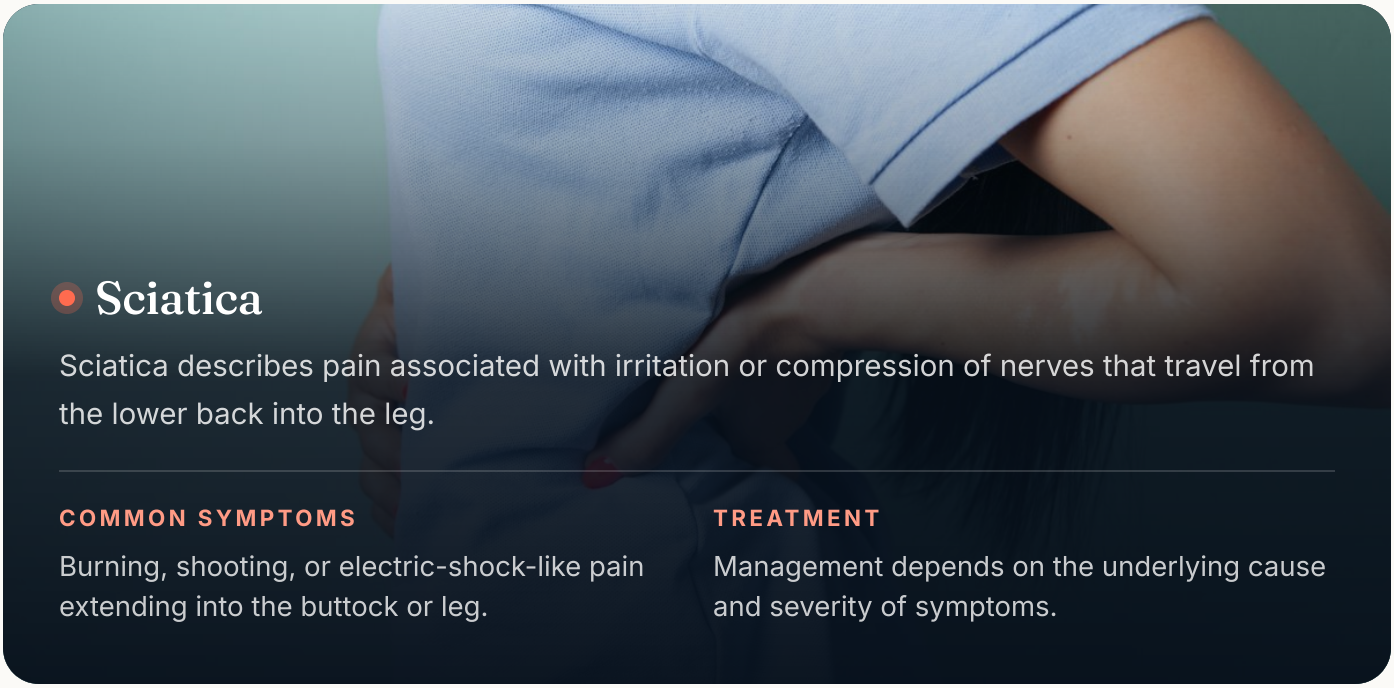
A slipped or herniated disc occurs when disc material extends beyond its normal position and may irritate or compress nearby nerves.

COMMON SYMPTOMS

Lower back pain, shooting leg pain, tingling, numbness, or muscle weakness.

TREATMENT

Depending on the symptoms and findings, treatment may include conservative care or surgical removal of the compressing disc material.



Sciatica

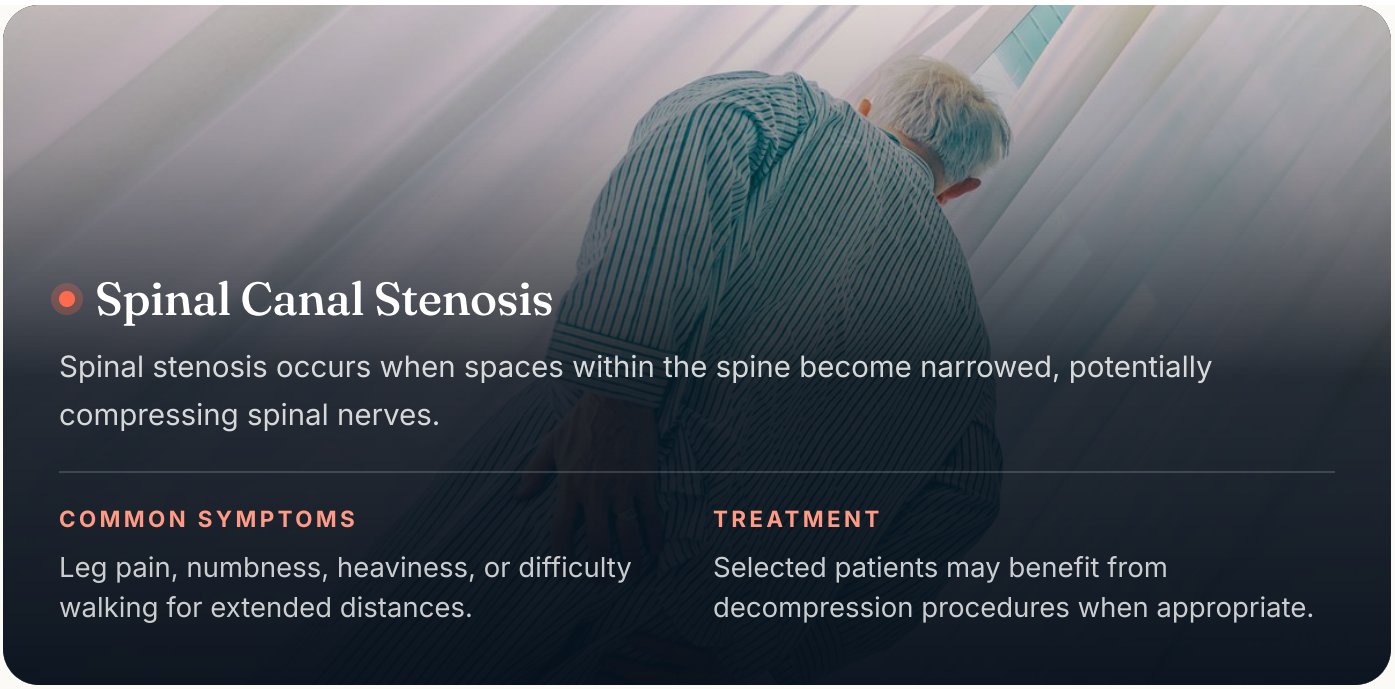
Sciatica describes pain associated with irritation or compression of nerves that travel from the lower back into the leg.

COMMON SYMPTOMS

Burning, shooting, or electric-shock-like pain extending into the buttock or leg.

TREATMENT

Management depends on the underlying cause and severity of symptoms.



Spinal Canal Stenosis

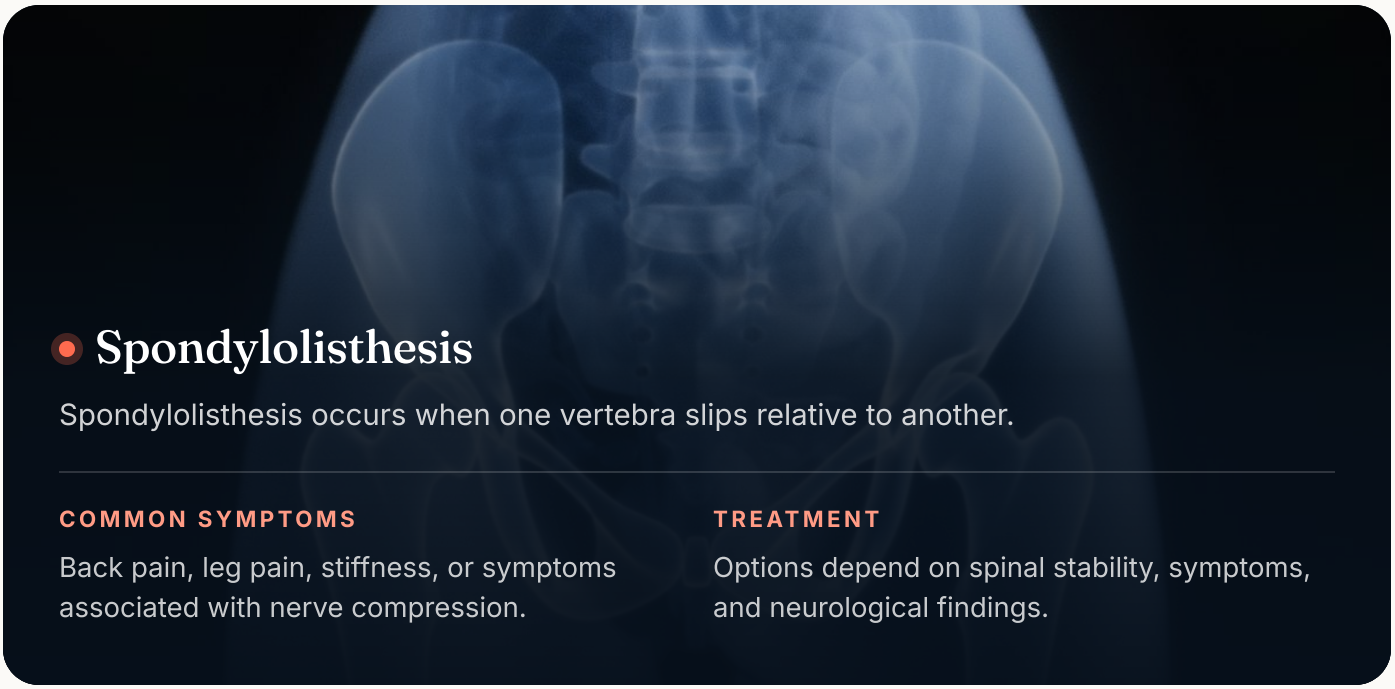
Spinal stenosis occurs when spaces within the spine become narrowed, potentially compressing spinal nerves.

COMMON SYMPTOMS

Leg pain, numbness, heaviness, or difficulty walking for extended distances.

TREATMENT

Selected patients may benefit from decompression procedures when appropriate.



Spondylolisthesis

Spondylolisthesis occurs when one vertebra slips relative to another.

COMMON SYMPTOMS

Back pain, leg pain, stiffness, or symptoms associated with nerve compression.

TREATMENT

Options depend on spinal stability, symptoms, and neurological findings.



Spondylosis

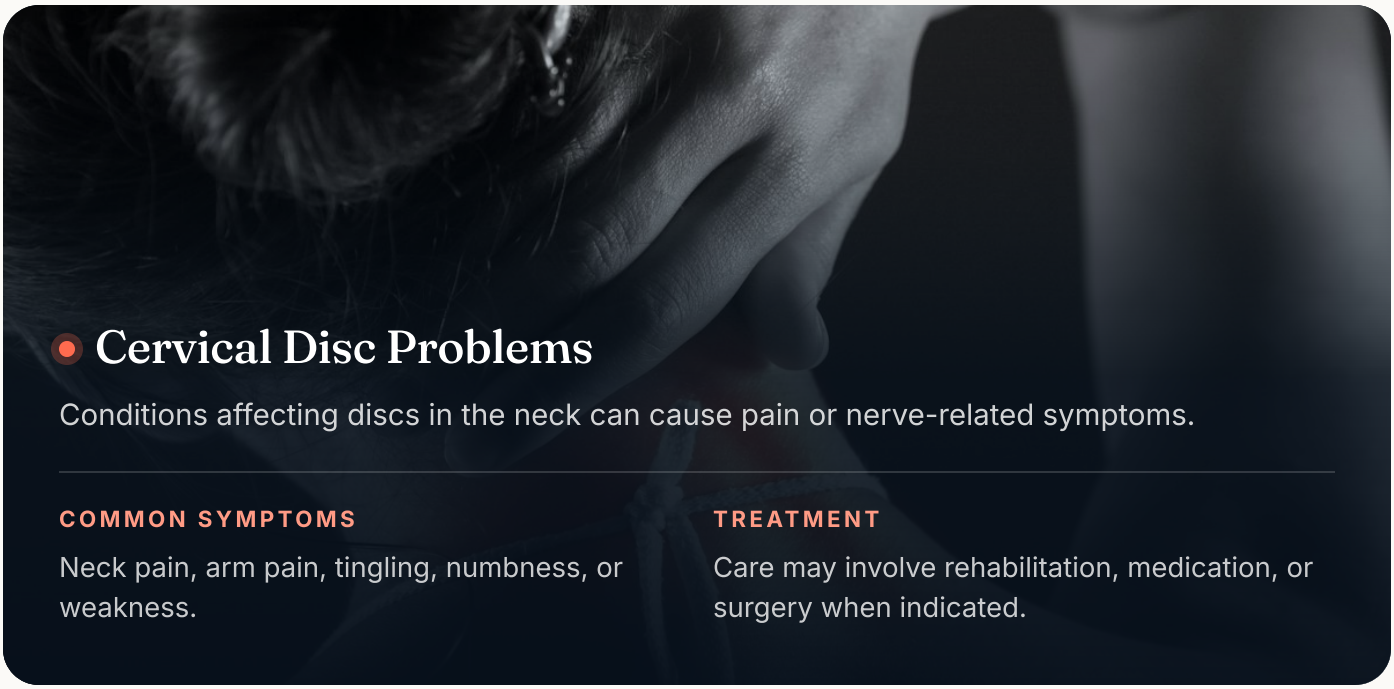
Spondylosis describes age-related wear of the spinal discs and joints. It can affect the neck or the lower back and may narrow the spaces around the nerves.

COMMON SYMPTOMS

Neck or back pain and stiffness; if nerves are compressed, radiating pain, numbness, or weakness in the arms or legs.

TREATMENT

Often managed with physiotherapy and medication. Surgery may be considered when nerve compression causes persistent or progressive symptoms.



Cervical Disc Problems

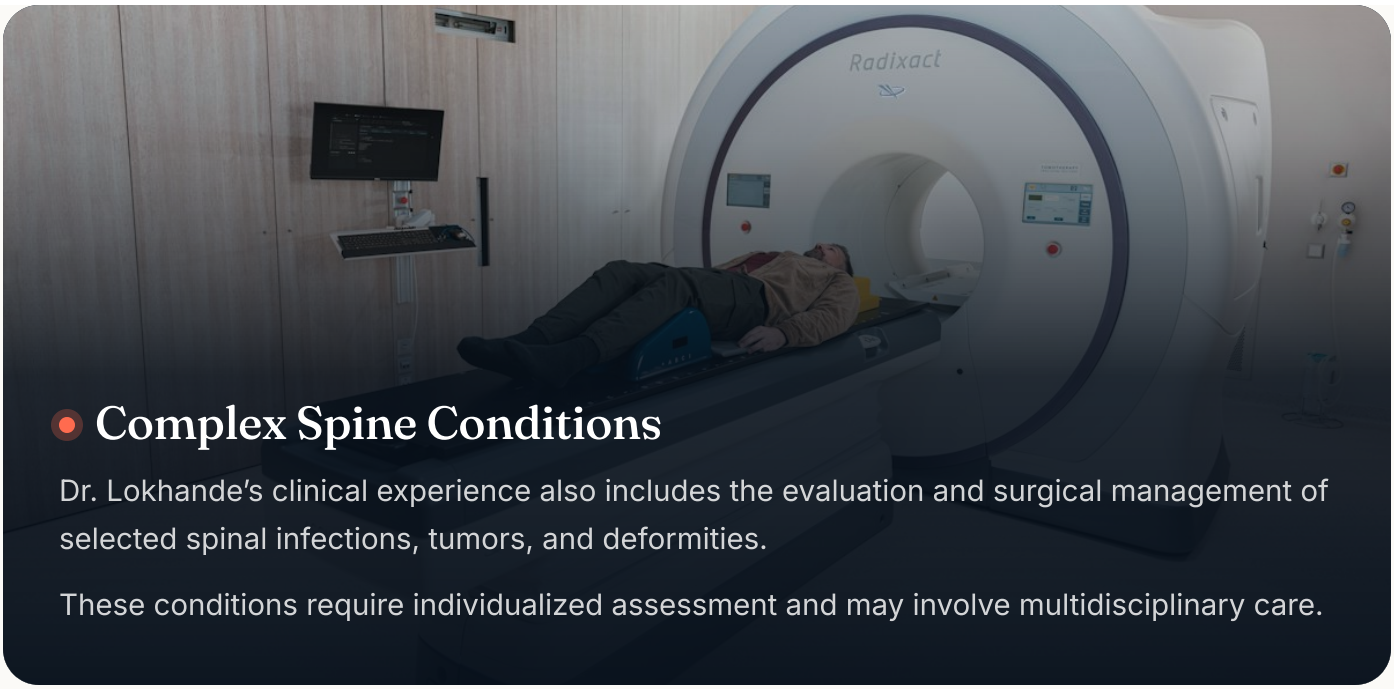
Conditions affecting discs in the neck can cause pain or nerve-related symptoms.

COMMON SYMPTOMS

Neck pain, arm pain, tingling, numbness, or weakness.

TREATMENT

Care may involve rehabilitation, medication, or surgery when indicated.



Complex Spine Conditions

Dr. Lokhande's clinical experience also includes the evaluation and surgical management of selected spinal infections, tumors, and deformities.

These conditions require individualized assessment and may involve multidisciplinary care.

Not Sure What's Causing Your Symptoms?

An accurate diagnosis is the first step toward selecting appropriate treatment.

Book a Spine Consultation

UNDERSTANDING YOUR OPTIONS

Endoscopic or Open Spine Surgery — What's the Difference?

Both approaches have important roles in spine treatment. The most appropriate technique depends on your diagnosis, anatomy, medical condition, and surgical goals.

Aspect	Full Endoscopic Surgery	Traditional Open Surgery
Surgical access	Small incision with specialized instruments.	Larger exposure may be required.
Visualization	High-definition endoscopic camera.	Direct surgical view, sometimes assisted by magnification.
Tissue disruption	Often reduced for suitable procedures.	Depends on the procedure and surgical approach.
Hospital stay	May be shorter in selected patients.	Varies according to surgical complexity.
Recovery	Can allow earlier mobilization in appropriate cases.	Depends on the condition and operation.
Suitability	Selected conditions and procedures.	May be necessary for complex conditions requiring wider exposure, reconstruction, or stabilization.

Which Approach Is Better?

There is no single technique that is best for every patient. The right choice depends on achieving the required treatment safely and effectively.

Discuss Your Symptoms

EXPERIENCE BEYOND THE OPERATING ROOM

A Spine Surgeon Who Also Teaches Other Surgeons.

Dr. Pramod Lokhande's work extends beyond clinical practice. He participates in surgical education, sharing his knowledge of endoscopic spine techniques with orthopedic surgeons and neurosurgeons.



International Fellowship Training

Advanced spine training in South Korea, Germany, France, Switzerland, and Japan.



National and International Conferences

Invited lectures and educational presentations on advanced spine surgery techniques.



Live Surgical Demonstrations

Teaching surgical techniques through demonstrations and educational programs.



Cadaveric Training Workshops

Hands-on training in endoscopic approaches, including interlaminar and transforaminal techniques.



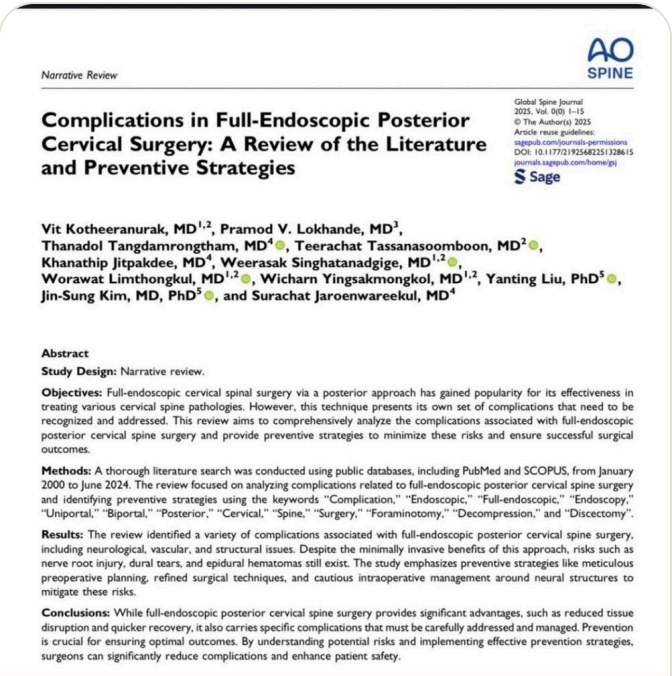
EUROSPINE Annual Meeting 2026

Live Demonstration — Meet the Expert



RIWOspine Lunch Symposium

30 Years Evolution of Endoscopic Spine Surgery



Narrative Review

AO SPINE

Complications in Full-Endoscopic Posterior Cervical Surgery: A Review of the Literature and Preventive Strategies

Global Spine Journal
2025, Vol. 0(0) 1–15
© The Author(s) 2025
Article reuse guidelines:
sagepub.com/journals-permissions
DOI: 10.1177/21925682251328615
journals.sagepub.com/home/gsj
Sage

Vit Kotheeranurak, MD[1,2], Pramod V. Lokhande, MD[3], Thanadol Tangdamrongtham, MD[4], Teerachat Tassanasoomboon, MD[2], Khanathip Jitpakdee, MD[4], Weerasak Singhatanadgige, MD[1,2], Worawat Limthongkul, MD[1,2], Wicharn Yingsakmongkol, MD[1,2], Yanting Liu, PhD[5], Jin-Sung Kim, MD, PhD[5], and Surachat Jaroenwareekul, MD[4]

Abstract

Study Design: Narrative review.

Objectives: Full-endoscopic cervical spinal surgery via a posterior approach has gained popularity for its effectiveness in treating various cervical spine pathologies. However, this technique presents its own set of complications that need to be recognized and addressed. This review aims to comprehensively analyze the complications associated with full-endoscopic posterior cervical spine surgery and provide preventive strategies to minimize these risks and ensure successful surgical outcomes.

Methods: A thorough literature search was conducted using public databases, including PubMed and SCOPUS, from January 2000 to June 2024. The review focused on analyzing complications related to full-endoscopic posterior cervical spine surgery and identifying preventive strategies using the keywords "Complication," "Endoscopic," "Full-endoscopic," "Endoscopy," "Uniportal," "Biportal," "Posterior," "Cervical," "Spine," "Surgery," "Foraminotomy," "Decompression," and "Discectomy".

Results: The review identified a variety of complications associated with full-endoscopic posterior cervical spine surgery, including neurological, vascular, and structural issues. Despite the minimally invasive benefits of this approach, risks such as nerve root injury, dural tears, and epidural hematomas still exist. The study emphasizes preventive strategies like meticulous preoperative planning, refined surgical techniques, and cautious intraoperative management around neural structures to mitigate these risks.

Conclusions: While full-endoscopic posterior cervical spine surgery provides significant advantages, such as reduced tissue disruption and quicker recovery, it also carries specific complications that must be carefully addressed and managed. Prevention is crucial for ensuring optimal outcomes. By understanding potential risks and implementing effective prevention strategies, surgeons can significantly reduce complications and enhance patient safety.

Published research

Complications in Full-Endoscopic Posterior Cervical Surgery: A Review



Docs save 12-yr-old boy from paralysis with spine surgery

Steffy.Thevar@timesofindia.com

Pune: Doctor's in a city hospital recently performed a full endoscopic internal gibbectomy on a 12-year-old patient suffering from a rare spinal deformity.

The boy could walk again within12 hours of surgery without needing any support. Twelve-year-old Divyansh* (name changed) started facing nagging backache, difficulty in walking and loss of bladder control three years ago. After numerous consultations, Divyansh was diagnosed with rare and complex spinal deformity —congenital thoracic kyphosis.

Divyansh's condition was extremely rare. According to doctors, such congenital spinal anomalies affect only 2-5 percent of patients in a lakh. Dr Pramod Lokhande, consultant spine surgeon at Jupiter Hospital said, "While the exact cause is not always clear, some cases are linked to genetic factors such as consanguineous (within family) marriages, which can increa-

CHALLENGING OPERATION

The boy's rare condition of congenital thoracic kyphosis was caused by fusion of two vertebrae at **T4 and T5 levels**

- This fusion created a bony hump inside his spine, known as an internal gibbus, which pressed hard on his spinal cord, slowly paralyzing him
- He was unable to walk for three years
- The operation was challenging as the spine segment was very close to the heart
- So, the doctor made a minimal incision to help avoid any trauma to the heart
- **The boy could walk on his feet within 12 hours of the surgery**

vertebrae at T4 and T5 levels.

"This fusion created a bony hump inside his spine, known as an internal gibbus, which pressed hard on his spinal cord. The pressure was slowly paralyzing him. He was unable to walk for three years. If we had not operated on him, he would have lost the ability to walk completely and ended up in a wheelchair," said Dr Lokhande. Dr Lokhande claimed that this is the first such case in the world wherein a patient underwent a full endoscopic internal gibbectomy — that required no

scopic transforaminal internal gibbectomy under general anesthesia and neuromonitoring using just a 1 cm incision and an 8 mm endoscope, surgeons were able to precisely remove the bone compressing the spinal cord.

The procedure lasted about five hours and within 12 hours of surgery, Divyansh was up on his feet walking in the hospital's corridor without any support.

"The next morning, around 10 am, we made him sit on the bed and walk a few steps," Dr Lokhande said. By April

In the news

"Docs save 12-yr-old boy from paralysis with spine surgery"

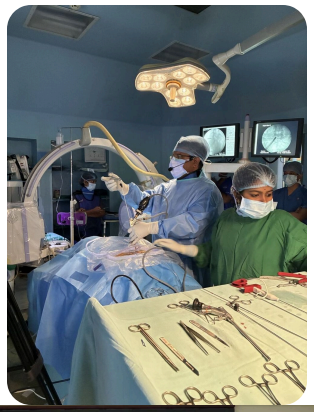






















FOR ORTHOPEDIC SURGEONS AND NEUROSURGEONS

Interested in learning full endoscopic spine surgery?

Explore Dr. Lokhande’s educational activities, workshops, and professional training opportunities.

Book a Fellowship









SURGEON TRAINING

Book a Fellowship

Tell us about your background and the training you are interested in. Your enquiry will be sent to Dr. Lokhande, and the team will contact you about availability and next steps.

- Fellowship in full endoscopic spine surgery
- Cadaveric training workshops
- Live surgical demonstrations
- Observership

Submitting an enquiry does not confirm a place. Programme dates, eligibility and any fees will be confirmed by the team.

Fellowship Enquiry

Fields marked with an asterisk (*) are required.

Preview: online enquiries are not connected yet. Submitting this form will not send your details.

Full Name *

Email Address *

Mobile Number *

Include your country code, e.g. +91 98765 43210

Specialty *

Select an option

Hospital / Institution *

City & Country *

Years in Practice

Select an option

Experience with Endoscopic Spine Surgery

Select an option

Programme of Interest *

- [ ] Fellowship
- [ ] Cadaveric workshop

☐ Live surgical demonstration ☐ Observership

Preferred Month or Dates

e.g. March 2027, or flexible

Message (Optional)

☐ I agree to be contacted about my fellowship enquiry. I understand that submitting this form does not confirm a training place. I have read the Privacy Notice. *

Send Fellowship Enquiry

WHAT TO EXPECT

Your Journey Begins with Understanding Your Spine.

01

Request an Appointment

Share your contact information, preferred consultation location, and main concern.

02

Clinical Consultation

Discuss your symptoms, medical history, previous treatment, and current difficulties.

03

Review of Investigations

Your doctor may review existing MRI or other imaging and recommend further investigations if necessary.

04

Understand Your Options

Receive an explanation of your diagnosis and available treatment choices.

05

Make an Informed Decision

If surgery is recommended, discuss the expected benefits, risks, alternatives, costs, and recovery plan before deciding.

06

Follow-Up and Rehabilitation

Receive appropriate follow-up guidance and recommendations for recovery.

Your health. Your questions. An informed decision.

Book a Spine Consultation

YOUR QUESTIONS ANSWERED

Common Questions About Spine Treatment

Discuss Your Symptoms

Does every slipped disc require surgery?

No. Many people with disc herniation improve with non-surgical treatment. Surgery may be considered when symptoms remain severe, neurological problems develop, or conservative treatment is unsuccessful.

What is full endoscopic spine surgery?

It is a minimally invasive surgical technique that uses a small camera and specialized instruments to treat selected spinal conditions through a small incision.

Is endoscopic spine surgery safe?

Endoscopic spine surgery is an established technique for selected conditions. However, every operation carries risks, including infection, bleeding, nerve injury, persistent symptoms, or the need for further surgery. Your surgeon will explain the risks relevant to your condition.

Can endoscopic surgery treat sciatica?

Some patients with sciatica caused by a herniated disc or other forms of nerve compression may be suitable for endoscopic decompression. The decision depends on clinical examination and imaging.

How soon can I walk after surgery?

Some patients can begin walking on the day of surgery. However, this depends on the procedure, their medical condition, and the surgeon’s instructions.

How long will I need to stay in the hospital?

Selected endoscopic procedures may allow same-day or next-day discharge. Other procedures may require a longer stay.

Will my back pain disappear completely?

No treatment can guarantee complete pain relief. Outcomes depend on the cause of pain, duration of symptoms, nerve health, procedure, and other individual factors.

What if I have already been advised to undergo open spine surgery?

You may request a specialist consultation to understand whether other treatment approaches are appropriate. An alternative technique is not necessarily better or suitable in every case.

Can I consult Dr. Lokhande if I already have an MRI?

Yes. Bring your MRI report, available images, previous prescriptions, and relevant medical records to your consultation.

What is the cost of endoscopic spine surgery?

The cost depends on the diagnosis, hospital, procedure, medical requirements, and other factors. A treatment estimate can be discussed after clinical evaluation.

Where can I consult Dr. Lokhande?

Consultation arrangements are available in Pune and Mumbai. Please contact the appointment team for verified clinic locations and schedules.

When should I seek urgent medical attention?

New loss of bladder or bowel control, numbness around the groin or saddle area, or rapidly worsening limb weakness requires urgent medical evaluation. Do not wait for a routine appointment.

TAKE THE NEXT STEP

Don’t Let Unanswered Questions About Your Spine Hold You Back.

Persistent back pain, sciatica, or difficulty walking can leave you uncertain about what to do next. A specialist consultation can help you understand your diagnosis, available treatments, and whether surgery may be appropriate.

Get an Expert Spine Opinion

Consult Dr. Pramod V. Lokhande to discuss your symptoms and treatment options.

⚠ **Urgent symptoms?** New loss of bladder or bowel control, numbness around the groin or saddle area, or rapidly worsening limb weakness needs urgent medical evaluation. Do not wait for a routine appointment.

Request a Spine Consultation

Please complete the form below. Our appointment team will contact you to discuss scheduling. Fields marked with an asterisk (*) are required.

Preview: online appointment requests are not connected yet. Submitting this form will not send your details.

Full Name *

Mobile Number *

10-digit Indian mobile number, e.g. 98765 43210

Email Address (Optional)

City *

Preferred Consultation Location *

- ○ Pune
- ○ Mumbai

What Is Your Main Concern?

How Long Have You Had Symptoms?

Select an option

Select an option

Do You Have an MRI Report?

- ○ Yes
- ○ No

Additional Information (Optional)

Please don’t upload or paste MRI images or detailed medical records here. Bring them to your consultation.

- ☐ I agree to be contacted by the appointment team regarding my enquiry. I understand that submitting this form does not establish a doctor–patient relationship or provide a medical diagnosis. I have read the Privacy Notice. *

Request Appointment

CONSULTATION

Consult Dr. Pramod V. Lokhande

Pune

Jupiter Hospital, Pune, Maharashtra

Full address, department and consultation schedule to be confirmed.

Mumbai

Clinic or hospital details to be confirmed.

Appointments

Phone	*To be confirmed*
Email	*To be confirmed*
Consultation hours	*To be confirmed*

Request Appointment

gurukrupa Spine Clinic

Passion Commitment Experience

Dr. Pramod V. Lokhande

NAVIGATION

Home

About

Conditions

Endoscopic Surgery

Expertise

Full Endoscopic & Minimally Invasive Spine Surgeon
Gurukrupa Spine Clinic

FAQs

Consultation

Privacy Notice

MEDICAL DISCLAIMER

The information on this website is intended for general education and does not replace professional medical advice, diagnosis, or treatment.

Treatment suitability, surgical risks, and recovery outcomes vary between individuals. A clinical consultation is required before making treatment decisions.

For urgent neurological symptoms or medical emergencies, seek immediate medical attention.

© 2026 Dr. Pramod V. Lokhande. All rights reserved.